which are relative to human interests. There are only particular points of view. No content can be given to the expression, 'absolute conception of reality'. The truth is just that there is no ultimate description of reality. This is what he calls 'the emptiness of emptiness'.

The realisation that everything is empty puts an end to conceptual construction. That is to say, we cease to believe that our concepts are describing objective reality. Insight into emptiness, the realisation that there are no absolute truths to be found, leads to a compassionate outlook and mental peace, as one is no longer disappointed by the search for certainties.

In the *Vigrahavyavartani* he defends an extreme form of scepticism: you cannot determine what the reliable means of knowledge (***pramana***) are unless you have decided what things there are to be known (*prameya*); you cannot ascertain what things there are to be known, until you have identified the means of knowing.

When *Nagarjuna* says that he is not proposing a thesis of his own, he means that he is not presenting an alternative version of the *Abhidharmika* realists' comprehensive descriptions of objective reality. Moreover, attachment to dogmatically held viewpoints is spiritually damaging.

See ***Madhyamaka Buddhism***, ***Shunyata***

Further reading: K. Bhattacharya 1998; Burton 1999; Garfield 1995; Lindtner 1982; Murti 1955; Siderits 2003; Williams 1989

Nairatyma (no soul): according to all Buddhist schools there is no further fact called soul over and above the stream of ever-changing experiences. We can claim this because we have no cognition (*anupalabdhi*) of such an entity although it is the sort of thing that would be known if it existed.